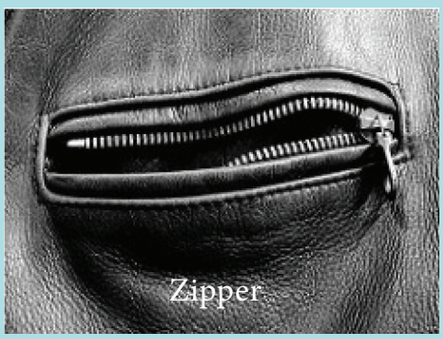
When were Zippers invented?

Zippers were invented in 1893 to speed up the process of buttoning shoes and boots, and they were soon adapted to pants and skirts.



Zipper

use of the garment. It can be used as a casing or can be stitched directly on the garment. Some of the common types of elastic are-

(i) **Braided Elastic:** This elastic narrows when stretched and so used for casing.

(ii) **Woven Elastic:** The width of the elastic remains same even when stretched and so can be stitched directly to the garment or for casing.

(iii) **Elastic Thread:** It is also called Bobbin Elastic. It is very thin elastic covered with thread all around and is mostly used in bobbins for giving shirring effect.

(iv) **Special Purpose Elastic:** Special elastics are available for pajamas, lungies and swim-wear.

12.4.3.1.6 Tapes and Cords

Different types of tapes and cords are available which are both functional as well as decorative. They come in a variety of types, widths and colours and its selection should depend mainly on its end use. Some of the common tapes available are-

(i) **Seam Tape:** Seam tapes are woven or lace tapes. They are used to finish hem and facing edges.

(ii) **Binding Tape:** Binding tapes are used for binding curved or straight edges and for casings.

(iii) **Twill Tape:** Twill tapes are mostly used for reinforcing seams.

(iv) **Piping:** Piping tapes are narrow bias strip of fabrics that can be inserted into a seam for decorative purpose.

(v) **Hem Facing:** Hem facing tapes are wide bias tape or lace which is used on facing hems and binding edges.

(vi) **Ribbon Tape:** Ribbon tapes are knitted bands which are stretchable and can be used to finish necklines, arm holes, sleeve, leg or waistline.

12.4.3.1.7 Velcro

Velcro is the commercial name for loop and hook fasteners. Velcro is a set of two tapes one with a looped napped surface and other with a hooked napped surface. When both the surfaces are pressed together they grip and remain locked until pulled apart. They are usually made of nylon and are available in meters. They are used on cuffs, plackets, mosquito nets and other such items. Velcro is popular in infant garments.

12.4.3.1.8 Buckles

Buckles are one of the most interesting types of fasteners. Buckles are available in plastic, iron, brass, steel and other

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